

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Next-Gen Childcare Management & Family Experience Platform

Developer-Ready BRD | Australia

Document	Business Requirements Document (BRD)
Version	2.0 – Developer Ready
Target Market	Australia
Primary Users	Centre owners/operators, administrators, educators, parents/guardians
Platforms	Parent mobile app, Educator mobile/tablet app, Centre web portal
Status	Product definition / development briefing

Confidential product concept – intended for evaluation and software development discussions.

1. Executive Summary

The proposed product is a modern, mobile-first childcare management and family experience platform for the Australian early childhood education and care market. It will connect parents, educators and centre management through a single ecosystem covering daily care, learning documentation, communication, attendance, enrolment, incidents, medication, billing, staffing and operational reporting.

The product is designed around three outcomes: reduce administrative workload for educators; give parents a simple and trustworthy view of their child’s day; and give centres reliable operational and compliance visibility.

Product principle: technology should support better care, not distract educators from children.

2. Product Vision & Objectives

Vision: Create a trusted childcare technology platform that helps educators spend more time with children, helps parents feel connected and informed, and helps centres operate safely, efficiently and transparently.

- Provide a simple, fast and reliable experience across parent, educator and centre workflows.
- Reduce repetitive educator documentation through quick capture, group actions and intelligent assistance.
- Make important parent information easy to find and distinguish urgent actions from routine updates.
- Provide transparent, understandable billing and CCS-related information.
- Create a strong privacy and child-safety architecture suitable for sensitive children’s information and media.
- Support Australian early learning frameworks and relevant regulatory/compliance workflows.
- Provide an extensible architecture capable of supporting single centres and multi-site operators.

3. Target Users & Personas

Persona	Primary Needs	Key Product Outcomes
Parent / Guardian	Child updates, communication, attendance, for	Confidence, transparency, low-friction actions
Educator	Fast care records, observations, photos, learning	Less documentation time, accurate records
Centre Director / Owner	Operations, staffing, occupancy, compliance, re	Real-time visibility and control
Administrator	Enrolments, family records, billing, documents	Efficient workflows and fewer errors
Area / Enterprise Manager	Multi-centre oversight and analytics	Consistent governance and reporting

4. Business Problems to Solve

- Parent information overload: important messages, actions and child updates can become mixed together.
- Notification fatigue: parents may receive too many low-priority notifications and miss important information.
- Educator administration: routine care and learning records can consume time better spent with children.
- Duplicated data entry: attendance, care records and learning documentation can require repetitive entry.
- Billing complexity: families can struggle to understand fees, subsidy information and gap payments.
- Operational fragmentation: centres may rely on multiple disconnected workflows or systems.

- Reliability and support: authentication, sync, media and notification failures create operational friction.
- Privacy and child safety: children’s personal information, photographs and videos require strong access controls and governance.

5. Product Scope

In Scope – initial product ecosystem

- Parent iOS/Android mobile application.
- Educator iOS/Android mobile and tablet application.
- Responsive centre administration web portal.
- Secure backend services, APIs, database and audit services.
- Identity, authentication and role-based access control.
- Child, family, room and centre management.
- Attendance and sign-in/sign-out.
- Daily care records: meals, sleep, toileting, bottles and activities.
- Photos/media and family communication.
- Messaging and notification management.
- Medication and incident workflows.
- Learning observations and EYLF/MTOP-aligned documentation.
- Enrolment and document management.
- Billing and payment capabilities.
- CCS integration readiness and compliance workflows.
- Reporting and operational dashboards.
- Offline-first educator workflows.

Potential future scope: advanced AI assistant, predictive analytics, workforce optimisation, advanced multilingual capabilities and enterprise features.

6. Core User Experience Requirements

6.1 Parent – Child at a Glance

The parent home screen should provide a consolidated view of the child’s current day without requiring navigation through multiple modules.

Information	Example
Attendance	Checked in – 8:07 AM
Meals	Breakfast ✓ Lunch ✓
Sleep	12:35 PM – 2:05 PM
Activities	Creative play, outdoor play
Learning	New observation available
Media	3 new photos
Communication	1 centre message
Actions	Medication authorisation required

6.2 Intelligent Parent Inbox

- Urgent: incidents, medication, emergency notices, centre closure.
- Action Required: forms, approvals, payments, document updates.
- Child Update: meals, sleep, photos, learning updates.
- General: newsletters, events and non-urgent centre information.

6.3 Parent Family Account

- One account supporting multiple children and, where authorised, multiple centres.
- No repeated logout/login to switch between siblings.
- Role-based access for parents, guardians and authorised pickup persons.
- Configurable notification preferences.

7. Parent Mobile Application Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
PAR-001	Secure account registration/login with optional biometric authentication.	Must
PAR-002	View child-at-a-glance dashboard.	Must
PAR-003	Receive categorised push notifications.	Must
PAR-004	View daily care records and timestamps.	Must
PAR-005	View approved child photos/videos.	Must
PAR-006	Securely message centre/room according to permissions.	Must
PAR-007	Complete and sign digital forms.	Must
PAR-008	View attendance history and sign-in/out status.	Must
PAR-009	View invoices, payments, receipts and understandable fee breakdowns.	Must
PAR-010	View learning observations and child learning journey.	Should
PAR-011	Manage authorised pickup persons where permitted by centre policy.	Should
PAR-012	Choose notification preferences and digest behaviour.	Should
PAR-013	Support multiple languages for key parent-facing content.	Could

8. Educator Application Requirements

The educator experience must prioritise speed, low cognitive load and minimal screen interaction.

ID	Requirement	Priority
EDU-001	Record attendance/check-in status.	Must
EDU-002	One-tap/group logging for meals, sleep, toileting, bottles and activities.	Must
EDU-003	Capture photos against approved child/room context.	Must
EDU-004	Create observations and learning records.	Must
EDU-005	Support EYLF V2.0/MTOP V2.0-aligned documentation.	Must
EDU-006	Record medication administration with appropriate controls.	Must
EDU-007	Record incidents and initiate parent notification workflow.	Must

ID	Requirement	Priority
EDU-008	Work offline and synchronise automatically when connectivity returns.	Must
EDU-009	Show sync state and resolve/flag data conflicts safely.	Must
EDU-010	Allow educators to review/edit their submitted records according to permissions.	Should

9. Group Logging & Efficiency

The system should support a group-first workflow: an educator can record a common event once and then apply exceptions to individual children.

Example: 12 children have morning tea → educator records the group event once → adjusts individual exceptions only where required.

Product KPI: routine documentation time should be reduced by at least 40% compared with the centre's baseline process.

10. Learning & Curriculum Documentation

- Support EYLF V2.0 and, where applicable, MTOP V2.0.
- Observation → interpretation → learning outcome → evidence → reflection → next step workflow.
- Link evidence/media to observations where authorised.
- Search and filter by child, date, room, learning outcome and educator.
- Maintain educator approval/edit history.
- AI-assisted suggestions may be provided but must never automatically become an official educator assessment without human review.

11. AI-Assisted Features

AI is intended to reduce administrative effort, not replace professional judgement.

Capability	Example	Control
Learning documentation assistance	Suggest possible EYLF connections from an educator observation	Educator must review/approve
Centre assistant	Answer operational questions from authorised centre data	Role-based access + audit
Message drafting	Help draft routine parent communications.	Human review before sending
Summarisation	Summarise a child's recent documented learning journey	Authorised users only
Administrative assistance	Identify missing forms or upcoming expiries.	Rules + human verification

AI must not use children's photographs, videos or personal information to train external/general-purpose models without explicit lawful authority and appropriate consent/governance.

12. Centre Administration Web Portal

Module	Core Requirements
Dashboard	Children present, expected attendance, rooms, staff, alerts and actions.
Child & Family	Profiles, guardians, permissions, documents, health/medical information.
Enrolments	Enquiry, waitlist, offer, enrolment, document completion and onboarding.
Rooms	Room configuration, capacity, children and educators.

Module	Core Requirements
Attendance	Live attendance, history, corrections and audit trail.
Communication	Announcements, room messages, emergency broadcast and acknowledgement tracking.
Incidents	Record, notify, acknowledge, review and audit.
Medication	Authorisations, administration records, expiry alerts and audit.
Billing	Invoices, payments, balances, receipts and subsidy-related information.
Reporting	Operational, attendance, finance, learning and compliance reports.
Staff	Profiles, qualifications, availability, training and expiry monitoring.

13. Attendance, Pickup & Child Safety

- Support centre kiosk, QR/PIN and other approved attendance methods.
- Maintain exact timestamp and audit history for sign-in/out events.
- Maintain authorised pickup list with permissions and expiry.
- Support optional verification mechanisms according to centre policy.
- Provide clear exception handling for corrections and late changes.
- Location/geofencing, if offered, must be optional and privacy-minimised.

14. Medication & Incident Management

Medication: authorisation, medication details, dosage/instructions, expiry, administration timestamp, administering staff member, parent/guardian notification where required, audit history.

Incident: incident capture, relevant child/staff context, notes, evidence where appropriate, parent notification, acknowledgement, management review and immutable audit history.

15. Billing & Child Care Subsidy (CCS)

- Provide understandable gross fee, subsidy-related information, gap/out-of-pocket amount, payments and balance.
- Clearly distinguish estimated information from government-confirmed information.
- Support invoice history, receipts and payment status.
- Support configurable payment methods subject to selected payment provider.
- Design CCS connectivity around current Australian Government/Services Australia requirements and registered-software processes.
- Maintain reconciliation/audit records for relevant transactions and data exchanges.
- Do not represent third-party/government calculations as guaranteed where the platform does not control the source data.

Important: production CCS transaction functionality is subject to applicable Australian Government registration, testing, security, authentication and integration requirements.

16. Notifications & Communication

Requirement	Description
Priority levels	Urgent, action required, child update, general.
Push	Reliable push notifications with retry/error monitoring.
Fallback	Configurable SMS/email fallback for defined critical events.
Read/acknowledge	Track delivery, read and acknowledgement where required.
Digest	Group low-priority events to reduce notification fatigue.
Preferences	Parent-configurable preferences subject to centre policy.
Emergency	Separate emergency broadcast capability.

17. Media Management

- Store child media securely with role-based access.
- Associate media with child/room/activity according to permissions.
- Support configurable download/share controls.
- Prevent unauthorised cross-family visibility.
- Maintain media access/audit events where appropriate.
- Apply retention and deletion rules defined by centre policy and applicable law.
- Do not use child media for advertising or AI model training without appropriate lawful basis, consent and governance.

18. Privacy, Security & Compliance

- Design for the Australian Privacy Principles and applicable privacy obligations.
- Prepare for requirements arising from the Australian Children's Online Privacy Code as applicable.
- Encryption in transit and at rest.
- Role-based access control (RBAC).
- Least-privilege access.
- Multi-factor authentication for privileged/admin accounts.
- Secure password/session management.
- Comprehensive audit logging for sensitive operations.
- Data retention and deletion policies.
- Data export/access mechanisms where required.
- Tenant isolation for multi-centre environments.
- Security monitoring, vulnerability management, backups and disaster recovery.

19. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement / Target
Availability	Target 99.9% monthly service availability for production, excluding agreed maintenance.
Performance	Common mobile/web actions should normally respond within 2 seconds under normal operating conditions; ex
Offline	Educator critical workflows must remain usable during temporary connectivity loss.
Scalability	Architecture should support single-centre deployment through enterprise multi-site operators.

Area	Requirement / Target
Security	Security-by-design, encryption, RBAC, audit logs and secure SDLC.
Observability	Central logging, metrics, tracing, alerting and service health monitoring.
Backup	Automated backups with tested restoration procedures.
Disaster Recovery	Documented RPO/RTO targets to be agreed during technical design.
Accessibility	Web/mobile experience designed toward recognised accessibility standards.
Maintainability	API-first, modular architecture with automated testing and CI/CD.

20. Suggested Technical Architecture - To Be Designed by Development Team

The BRD does not prescribe a particular technology stack. The selected architecture must satisfy the functional, security, scalability and compliance requirements.

- Cloud-hosted, highly available backend.
- Secure REST and/or GraphQL API layer as appropriate.
- Relational transactional data store with appropriate object/media storage.
- Event/queue architecture for notifications and asynchronous processing where useful.
- Mobile applications for iOS and Android, with shared codebase considered where it does not compromise platform quality.
- Responsive web portal for centre administration.
- Central identity and access management service.
- Monitoring, logging and alerting platform.
- Automated CI/CD with separate development, test, staging and production environments.

21. Integrations

Integration Area	Requirement
CCS / Australian Government	Architecture must support applicable approved/registered integration pathways and security requirements.
Payments	Payment gateway supporting Australian payment methods and secure tokenisation.
Push Notifications	Apple/Google notification services.
Email/SMS	Transactional messaging provider with delivery monitoring.
Identity	Secure authentication and optional enterprise SSO capability for future phases.
Calendar	Optional future integration for events/appointments.
Accounting/Payroll	Future integration based on market validation.

22. Business Rules

- A user may only view child/family information permitted by their role and relationship.
- Sensitive child information must not be exposed to unauthorised family members or staff.
- Critical records must retain an audit history.
- Deleted/changed records must follow defined retention and audit rules.

- AI-generated content must be identifiable internally as AI-assisted and require appropriate human approval before becoming an official record.
- Centre administrators control configurable workflows within defined system limits.
- Government/third-party source information must be distinguished from platform-generated estimates.

23. Reporting & Analytics

- Daily attendance and occupancy.
- Expected vs actual attendance.
- Room and centre operational status.
- Outstanding parent actions.
- Medication and incident reporting.
- Enrolment/waitlist status.
- Billing/payment status.
- Learning documentation activity.
- Staff/qualification expiry alerts.
- Enterprise multi-centre reporting in later phases.

24. MVP Scope & Delivery Roadmap

Phase	Primary Capabilities
MVP / Phase 1	Parent app, educator app, centre portal, child/family/room management, attendance, daily care records, photos
Phase 2	Learning/EYLF workflows, enrolment, billing/payments, CCS integration, rostering, ratios, staff compliance, adva
Phase 3	AI assistant, AI documentation assistance, advanced analytics, multilingual intelligence, workforce optimisation,

25. Success Metrics / KPIs

Metric	Target / Direction
Educator documentation time	≥40% reduction against agreed baseline.
Parent task completion	90%+ of common parent tasks completed without support.
Child information discoverability	Target: today's key child information visible within 10 seconds.
Platform availability	≥99.9% monthly target for production.
Critical notification delivery	≥99% successful delivery target, subject to device/network limitations.
Parent engagement	≥80% monthly active parent users after onboarding period.
App satisfaction	Target ≥4.6/5 store rating, supported by in-product usability metrics.
Billing discrepancies	Zero unexplained platform-attributable calculation/data-processing defects.
Support	Reduction in avoidable support tickets through improved UX and self-service.

26. Acceptance Criteria - High Level

- Parent can securely log in and immediately see authorised child information.
- Educator can record routine care events in a minimal number of interactions.
- Educator can continue critical data entry when temporarily offline.

- Synchronisation preserves timestamps, authorship and audit history.
- Unauthorised users cannot access child records or media.
- Parent receives configured notifications for critical and routine events.
- Centre can view current attendance and operational status.
- Medication and incident workflows provide appropriate audit trails.
- Billing information is clearly separated into platform-calculated/estimated and externally confirmed information.
- The system provides adequate monitoring and logging to investigate failed notifications, sync issues and data-processing errors.

27. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Potential Impact	Mitigation
Regulatory/CCS complexity	Delayed integration or compliance issues	Early technical/regulatory discovery; dedicated integration works
Sensitive child data breach	Severe privacy/safety impact	Security-by-design, encryption, RBAC, audit, testing and incident
Overly complex UX	Low adoption by educators/parents	User testing, task-based UX metrics and iterative design.
Offline sync conflicts	Incorrect records	Conflict strategy, idempotency, timestamps and audit history.
AI hallucination/inaccurate suggestions	Incorrect learning/admin records	Human approval, guardrails, source grounding and audit.
Notification overload	Parents miss critical events	Priority classification and digest controls.
Large MVP scope	Cost/time overrun	Phased delivery with strict MVP boundary.

28. Research & Product Validation Requirements

Competitor app-store reviews are useful signals but are not a representative sample of the Australian childcare market. Before development is locked, the product team should conduct structured discovery with real users.

- Interview at least 5–10 centre directors/operators.
- Interview at least 10 educators across different room types.
- Interview at least 10 parents/guardians.
- Observe current attendance and daily-record workflows where permission is available.
- Map current billing/CCS workflows with a knowledgeable centre administrator.
- Test clickable prototypes before engineering major workflows.
- Validate MVP scope against willingness-to-pay and operational priorities.

29. Product Design Principles

- Child first: technology should support care rather than compete with it.
- One task, one obvious action: minimise cognitive load.
- Show what matters: prioritise urgent and actionable information.
- Fast by default: common workflows should take seconds.
- Offline by design: connectivity should not interrupt care documentation.
- Privacy by design: collect and expose only what is necessary.
- Human-in-the-loop AI: AI assists professionals; it does not silently make professional decisions.
- Explainability: financial and operational outcomes should be understandable.

- Auditability: important changes should be traceable.

30. Developer Deliverables Expected

- Solution architecture and technical design.
- Database/data model.
- API specification and integration design.
- UX/UI designs and interactive prototypes.
- Mobile applications for iOS and Android.
- Responsive centre administration portal.
- Backend services and infrastructure.
- Authentication/authorisation implementation.
- Notification and messaging services.
- Offline-sync implementation.
- Automated unit/integration/end-to-end tests.
- Security testing and remediation.
- CI/CD pipelines.
- Monitoring/logging/alerting.
- Technical documentation and API documentation.
- Deployment runbooks.
- User/admin training materials.
- Handover of source code, repositories, infrastructure configuration and intellectual property as contractually agreed.

31. Questions Developers Must Address in Proposal

- Recommended technology stack and rationale.
- Proposed architecture and hosting model.
- Estimated development team composition.
- Estimated delivery timeline by phase.
- Estimated development cost by phase.
- Third-party services and expected recurring costs.
- CCS integration approach and dependencies.
- Security/privacy architecture.
- Offline-sync strategy.
- Data migration approach for centres switching from existing systems.
- Testing strategy and quality gates.
- Support and maintenance model after launch.
- Approach to app-store deployment and ongoing releases.
- Approach to AI features and data privacy.
- How source code, cloud infrastructure, data and IP ownership will be handled.

32. Out of Scope for Initial MVP

- Full payroll processing.
- Complex accounting/GL functionality.
- Predictive child development or health scoring.

- Automated decisions about a child's development or wellbeing.
- Advertising based on children/family data.
- Unrestricted location tracking.
- Public social networking between families.
- Advanced enterprise workforce optimisation.
- Any AI capability that creates official records without human review.

33. Regulatory & Reference Considerations

The development team should validate the current legal and technical requirements before implementation and before production launch. Relevant areas include Australian Privacy Principles, children's online privacy requirements, National Quality Framework/EYLF requirements, Child Care Subsidy/CCSS processes, data security and applicable consumer/payment obligations.

The following sources should be treated as starting points for discovery rather than as a substitute for legal/compliance advice:

- Australian Government Department of Education – Child Care Subsidy and software provider information.
- Services Australia – Child Care Subsidy provider and PRODA information.
- ACECQA – National Quality Framework and approved learning frameworks.
- Office of the Australian Information Commissioner – Australian Privacy Principles and Children's Online Privacy Code.
- eSafety Commissioner – guidance on children's privacy and images.

34. Competitive Research – Product Implications

Review of publicly available competitor app-store feedback indicates recurring category-level themes around reliability, notifications, navigation, media, messaging, authentication, support and workflow friction. These findings should be treated as discovery signals and validated with Australian centres and families before becoming contractual requirements.

Observed Market Theme	BRD Response
Navigation/workflow friction	Child-at-a-glance and role-specific home screens.
Notification problems	Priority categories, digest and delivery monitoring.
Media/photo usability	Secure media permissions, filtering and child context.
Authentication/sign-in issues	Reliable identity service, biometric option and recovery flows.
Support frustration	In-app support, service status and escalation workflow.
Educator paperwork	Quick/group logging and offline-first design.
Billing confusion	Transparent, explainable billing presentation.

35. Final Product Positioning

Less paperwork for educators. More connection for parents. Better visibility for centres. Better support for children.

The product should be developed as an integrated childcare operating and family experience platform, rather than as a collection of disconnected features. Reliability, simplicity, privacy and educator efficiency should be treated as core product capabilities.

Appendix A – Requirement Priority Definitions

Priority	Definition
Must	Required for the relevant release to be considered viable.
Should	Important capability; may be phased if necessary without invalidating the release.
Could	Useful enhancement subject to capacity and validation.
Future	Not required for the current release; retained for roadmap consideration.

Appendix B – Source Notes

This BRD has been strengthened using publicly available competitor app-store feedback and Australian government/regulatory material reviewed during product research. App-store reviews are directional evidence only and should not be interpreted as statistically representative of all users.

Prepared as a developer briefing document. Regulatory, legal, privacy and CCS implementation requirements should be independently validated before production development and launch.